Synonyms & Antonyms (Set B)

Year 5 Accelerated · **Lesson Worksheet**

Worked Examples

Example 1: Give a synonym for 'happy'.

Answer: 'joyful' (or 'delighted', 'content') — a word with a very similar meaning.

Example 2: Give an antonym for 'generous'.

Answer: 'stingy' (or 'mean', 'selfish') — a word with the opposite meaning.

Example 3: Which word is the better synonym for 'enormous' in this sentence: 'The ___ wave crashed over the ship.' (big / colossal)

Answer: 'colossal' — it matches the intensity of 'enormous' far more closely than the milder word 'big'.

Core Practice (15 questions)

1. Give a synonym for 'quick'.
2. Give an antonym for 'quick'.
3. Give a synonym for 'brave'.
4. Give an antonym for 'brave'.
5. Which word is a synonym for 'tiny'? A) huge B) minuscule C) average D) tall E) wide
6. Which word is an antonym for 'loud'? A) noisy B) silent C) booming D) deafening E) shrill
7. Give a synonym for 'begin'.
8. Give an antonym for 'begin'.
9. Give a synonym for 'sad'.
10. Select ALL the words below that are synonyms for 'angry'. A) furious B) calm C) irritated D) content E) cross
11. Give an antonym for 'sad'.
12. Which word is a synonym for 'ancient'? A) modern B) antique C) new D) recent E) young
13. Give a synonym for 'strong'.
14. Give an antonym for 'strong'.
15. Which word is an antonym for 'empty'? A) vacant B) full C) hollow D) bare E) deserted

Applied Practice (15 questions)

1. Give a synonym for 'glance' that suggests a quick look.
2. Give a synonym for 'stare' that suggests a long, fixed look.
3. Explain the shade-of-meaning difference between 'glance' and 'stare'.

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4. Choose the best synonym for 'walked' in: "She ___ wearily into the house after the long day." A) walked B) trudged C) skipped D) dashed E) marched

5. Give an antonym for 'generous' that fits: "Unlike his generous sister, Tom was quite ___."

6. Choose the best antonym for 'delicious' in: "The stew was ___, nothing like the delicious meal we'd hoped for." A) tasty B) bland C) rich D) flavourful E) scrumptious

7. Give a synonym for 'ancient' that fits: "They explored the ___ ruins of the old castle."

8. Give a synonym for 'exhausted'.

9. Give an antonym for 'exhausted' that fits: "After a good night's sleep, she felt completely ___."

10. Select ALL the words below that could replace 'furious' in "The furious customer demanded a refund." A) irate B) pleased C) livid D) content E) enraged

11. Which word is closest in meaning to 'reluctant'? A) eager B) willing C) hesitant D) delighted E) keen

12. Give a word that is the opposite of 'reluctant' (meaning eager or willing).

13. Give a synonym for 'peculiar'.

14. Choose the best synonym for 'shouted' in: "He ___ across the field to get her attention." A) whispered B) murmured C) bellowed D) muttered E) sighed

15. Give a synonym for 'big' that fits: "The ___ elephant lumbered across the plain" (choose a word stronger than 'big').

Challenge (15 questions)

1. Rank these three synonyms for 'sad' from mildest to strongest: 'unhappy', 'devastated', 'gloomy'.

2. Which word best replaces 'look' in a sentence describing someone looking at something with admiration and longing? A) glare B) gaze C) glimpse D) peer E) scowl

3. Give a synonym for 'meticulous' that captures its sense of being extremely careful with detail.

4. Give an antonym for 'meticulous'.

5. Choose the best synonym for 'frugal' in: "She was ___ with her pocket money, saving most of it each week." A) wasteful B) thrifty C) generous D) extravagant E) lavish

6. Explain why 'thrifty' is a better fit than 'stingy' as a synonym for 'frugal' in a positive context, even though both relate to spending little.

7. Select ALL the words below that are antonyms for 'reluctant'. A) eager B) hesitant C) willing D) unwilling E) enthusiastic

8. Give a synonym for 'ambiguous'.

9. Give an antonym for 'ambiguous'.

10. Which word is closest in meaning to 'candid'? A) secretive B) honest C) evasive D) deceptive E) guarded

11. Choose the best antonym for 'candid' in: "Unlike his usually candid replies, his answer today felt oddly ___." A) truthful B) frank C) evasive D) blunt E) direct

12. Give a synonym for 'diminish'.

13. Give an antonym for 'diminish'.

14. Select ALL the words below could describe someone who is 'austere'. A) strict B) lenient C) severe D) indulgent E) stern

15. Give the word that describes excessive, unpleasant self-belief, in contrast to the positive word 'confident'.

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